TEXAS A&M UNIVERSITY

TAMU
Survey Results Aggregate

TAMU-College Station Student Course Evaluation (End-of-Term) Completed

Spring 2022 - College Station / Student Course Evaluation (End of Term) / Anonymous Survey

Course Assignments: 9113 / Survey Participants: 260275

Schedule: 12/24/2021 to 6/2/2022

Results Available: 6/3/2022

This survey completed on **Thursday, June 2, 2022** at **11:59PM**.

College:	Science
Department:	CS-Mathematics
Course Section:	MATH 168 - 502 FINITE MATHEMATICS
Course Section Director:	NA
Instructor:	Arpan Pal

Survey Overview / Course Section Results Aggregate

81%
Response Rate
42 of 52

TOTAL SURVEYS	SURVEYS COMPLETED
52	42
PENDING SURVEYS	**COURSE ASSIGNMENTS**
10	1

Survey Data / Course Section Results Aggregate

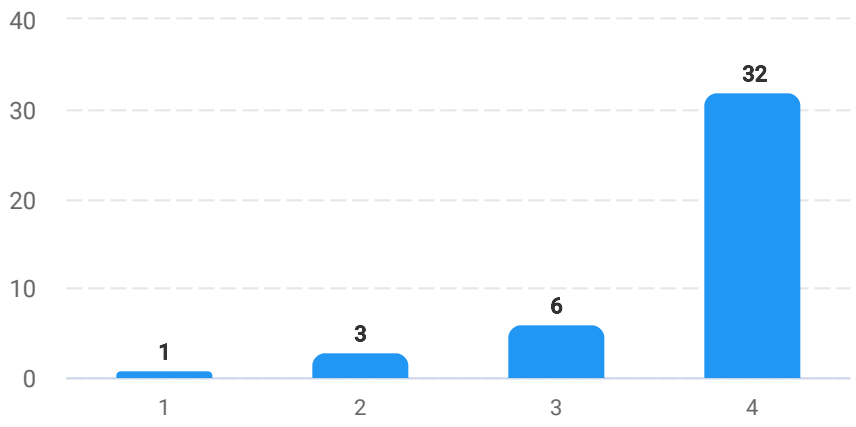
TAMU Student Course Evaluation

1. Begin this course evaluation by reflecting on your own level of engagement and participation in the course. What portion of the class preparation activities (e.g., readings, online modules, videos) and assignments did you complete?

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
1	<50%	1
2	50-70%	3
3	71-90%	6
4	>90%	32



Average
3.64

Median
4.00

Mode
4

Std. Dev.
0.72

Variance
0.52

Student Comments:

- I attended class every day and did all the assigned work.
- I had to q-drop this course.

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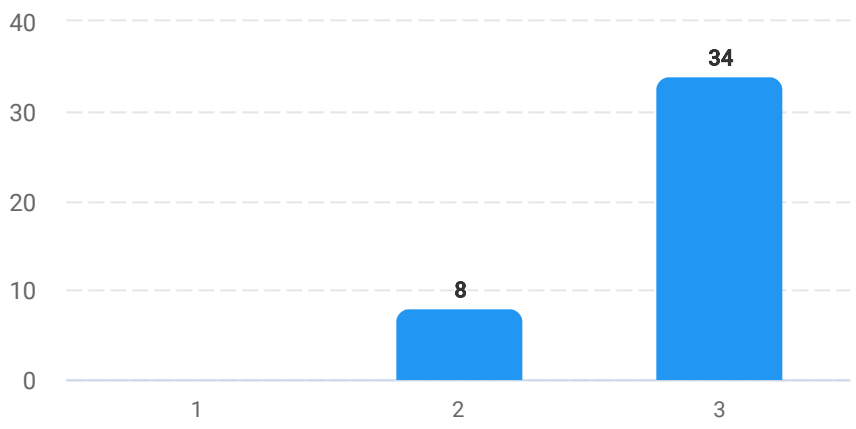
2 Based on what the instructor(s) communicated, and the information provided in the course syllabus, I understood what was expected of me.

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
1	No, I did not understand what was expected of me.	0
2	I partially understood what was expected of me.	8
3	Yes, I understood what was expected of me.	34



Average
2.81

Median
3.00

Mode
3

Std. Dev.
0.39

Variance
0.15

Student Comments:

- I had some expectation of what was expected of me, but upon coming to classes it had seemed to change.
- All instructions for work were straightforward and we always knew what was expected of us.

had expected

*

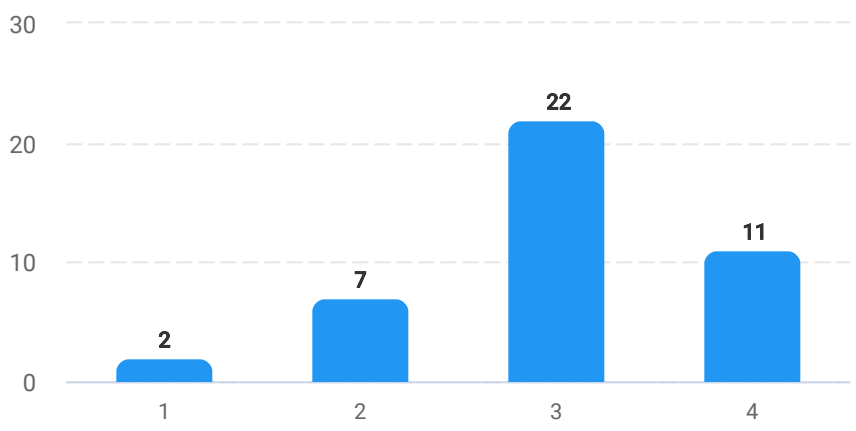
3

This course helped me learn concepts or skills as stated in course objectives/outcomes.

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
1	This course did not help me learn the concepts or skills.	2
2	This course only slightly helped me learn the concepts or skills.	7
3	This course moderately helped me learn the concepts or skills.	22
4	This course definitely helped me learn the concepts or skills.	11



Average
3.00

Median
3.00

Mode
3

Std. Dev.
0.79

Variance
0.62

Student Comments:

- I feel like I learned everything for the test. However, none of it stuck with me and I don't really know how to apply it.
- It helped me learn math however, it was mostly due to classmates, online textbooks, and week-in-reviews.
- Lectures went fast sometimes so I would have to go home and try to learn it my self.

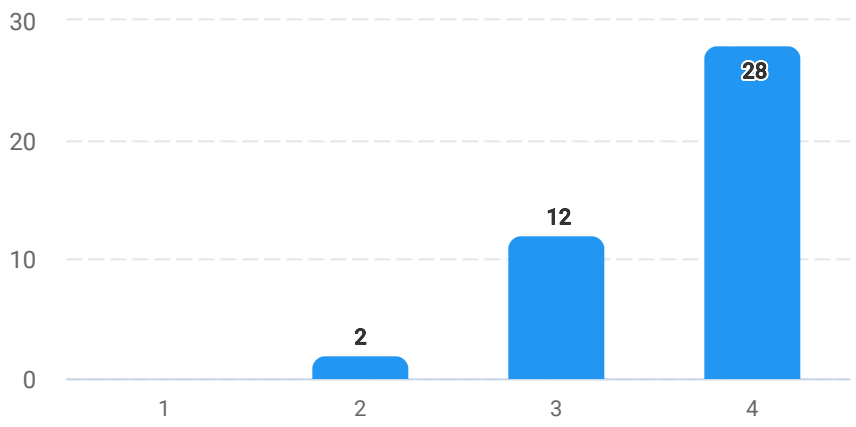
*

4 In this course, I engaged in critical thinking and/or problem solving.

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
1	Never	0
2	Seldom	2
3	Often	12
4	Frequently	28



Average
3.62

Median
4.00

Mode
4

Std. Dev.
0.58

Variance
0.33

Student Comments:

- Our work frequently forced us to engage in problem solving
- I engaged in it however I was often confuse.

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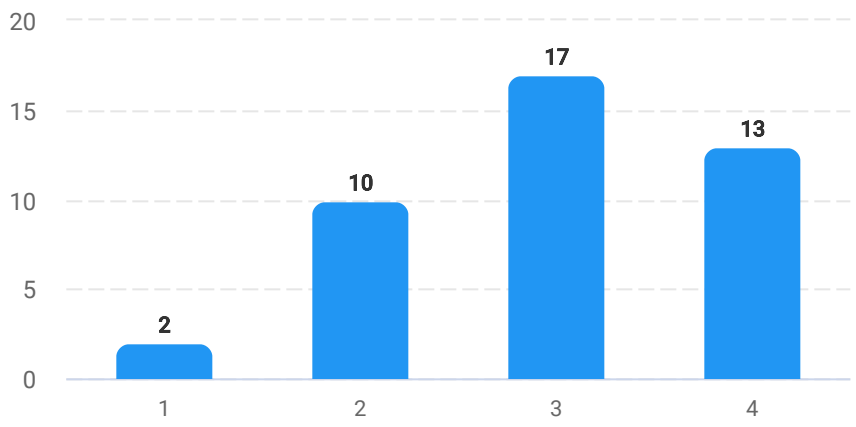
5 Please rate the organization of this course.

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
1	Not at all organized	2
2	Slightly organized	10
3	Moderately organized	17
4	Very well organized	13



Average
2.98

Median
3.00

Mode
3

Std. Dev.
0.86

Variance
0.74

Student Comments:

- The canvas page was set up very well. My one main complaint is that sometimes the notes wouldn't be posted until right before class, making it frustrating when I would have to handwrite long word problems and notes.
- Wish we could have known when some of the quizzes were
- Oftentimes, there would be lack of organization.

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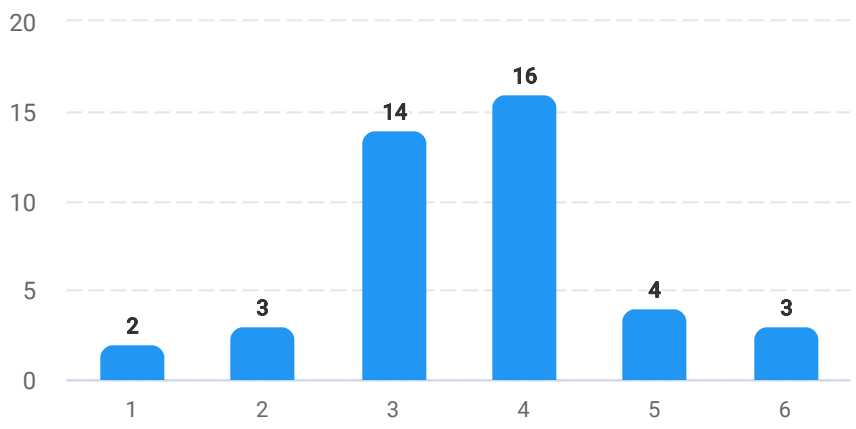
6

In this course, I learned to critically evaluate diverse ideas and perspectives.

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	2
2	Disagree	3
3	Neither agree nor disagree	14
4	Agree	16
5	Strongly agree	4
6	Not Applicable	3



Average
3.44

Median
4.00

Mode
4

Std. Dev.
0.96

Variance
0.91

Student Comments:

- Not the focus of this course
- It's math

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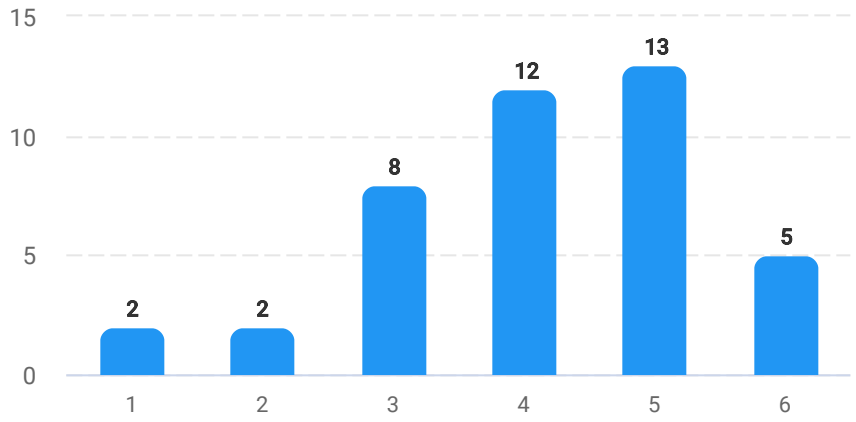
7

Feedback in this course helped me learn. *Please note, feedback can be either **informal** (e.g., in class discussion, chat boards, think-pair-share, office hour discussions, help sessions) or **formal** (e.g., written or clinical assessments, review of exams, peer reviews, clicker questions).*

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
1	No feedback was provided.	2
2	Feedback provided was not at all helpful.	2
3	Feedback provided was only slightly helpful.	8
4	Feedback provided was moderately helpful.	12
5	Feedback provided was very helpful.	13
6	Feedback provided was extremely helpful.	5



Average
4.12
Median
4.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev.
1.26
Variance
1.58

Student Comments:

- Generally, there was no feedback besides grades. We would occasionally go over quizzes but not always.
- Sometimes the feedback made me more confused
- There wasn't not much feed back at all, the most feedback we received was our quiz grades, because we could see them in canvas and he would hand them back. One questions asked, the feedback was often more confusing than the question and not even directed towards the question that was asked.
- good office hours always answered questions

question

feedback

questions
more
grades

*

8

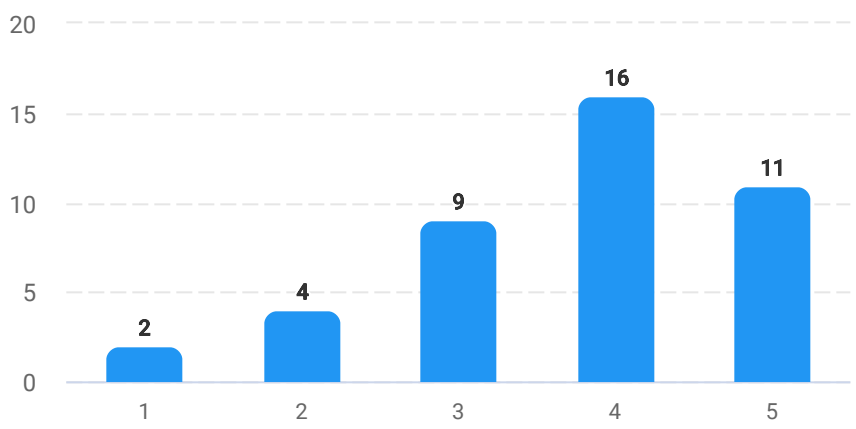
The instructor fostered an effective learning environment.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Institution Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Strongly disagree	2
2	Disagree	4
3	Neither agree nor disagree	9
4	Agree	16
5	Strongly agree	11



Average
3.71
Median
4.00
Mode
4
Std. Dev.
1.10
Variance
1.20

Student Comments:

- I don't feel like we were really made to understand the concepts. Additionally, the fact that all of our quizzes were pop quizzes made planning for this class frustrating. It often felt like we didn't have a chance to learn the material before we took the quiz over it.
- good instructor
- There were times when concepts would not be well explained, or what was expected on quizzes/ exams was not made clear. However, the professor would clarify anytime questions were asked. It was just difficult to get information sometimes without asking a lot of questions.

9

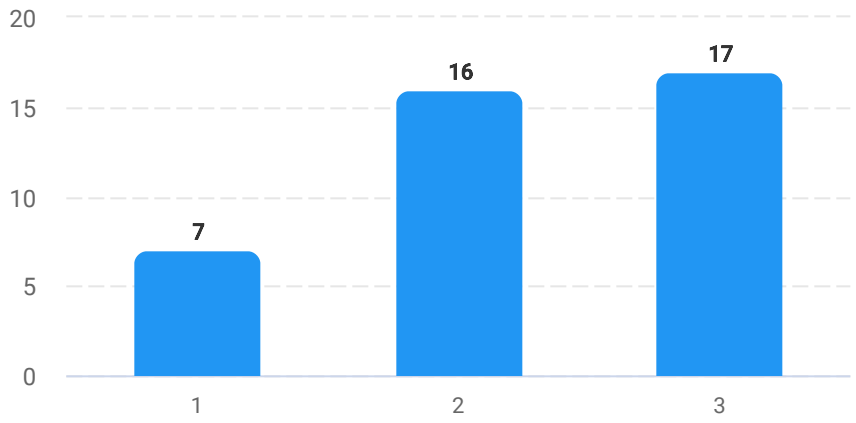
The instructor's teaching methods contributed to my learning.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Institution Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Did not contribute	7
2	Contributed a little	16
3	Contributed a lot	17



Average
2.25
Median
2.00
Mode
3
Std. Dev.
0.73
Variance
0.54

Student Comments:

- They were fairly boring and difficult to follow
- I went to the help sessions and that is the only reason why I am passing in this class.
- I liked the notes they were not confusing like some other math classes, just not great lectures
- Great person, just not that great of a teacher.
- Oftentimes, the work in the notes would not reflect the homework. Also, sometimes there would be an easier way to explain a concept, but it would be explained in a very complicated way that just ended up confusing many students.

10

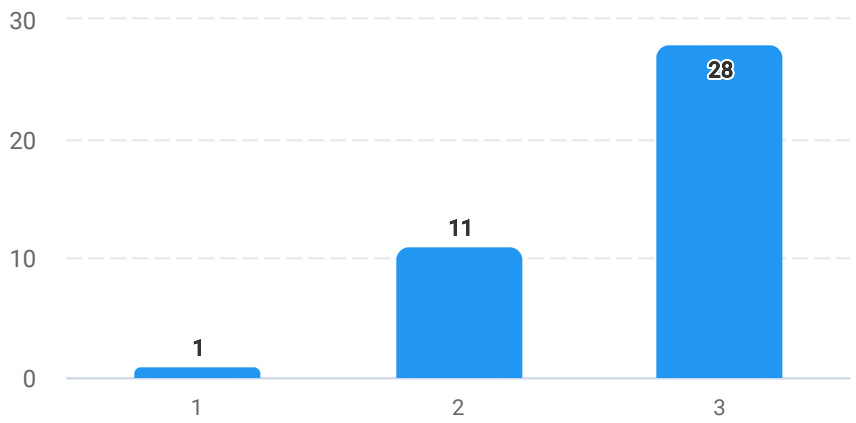
The instructor encouraged students to take responsibility for their own learning.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Institution Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	Did not encourage	1
2	Sometimes encouraged	11
3	Frequently encouraged	28



Average
2.68

Median
3.00

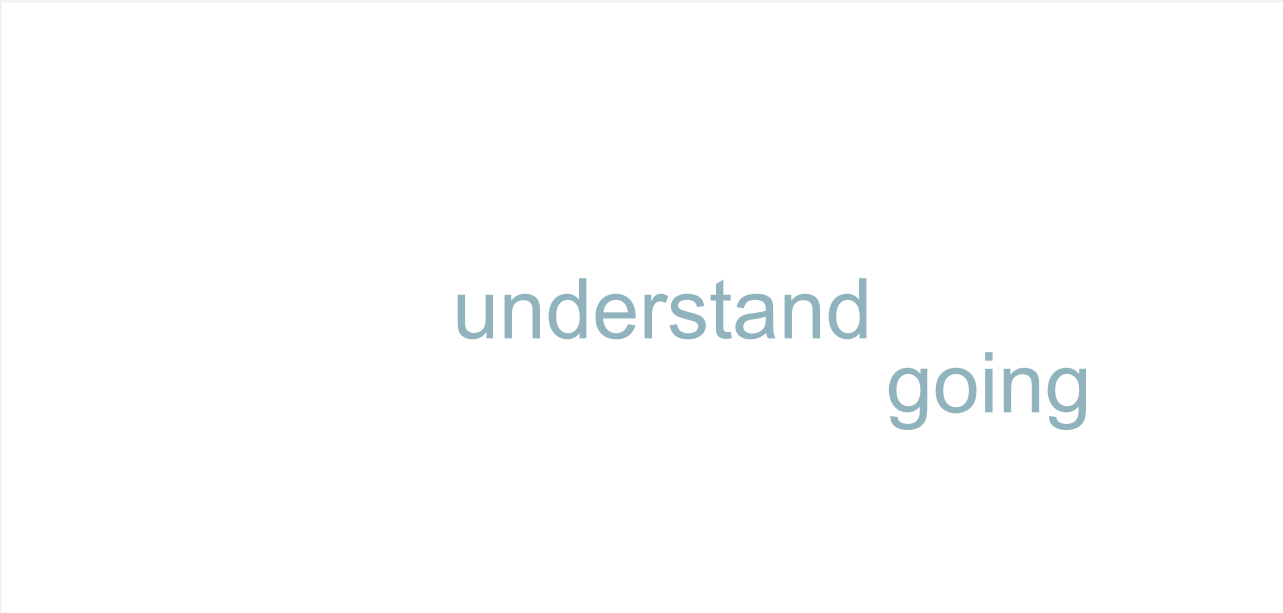
Mode
3

Std. Dev.
0.52

Variance
0.27

Student Comments:

- Encouraged because they otherwise wouldn't understand unless they learned on their own
- We kind of had to in order to understand what was going on, because if we didn't, we would never know what was going on.



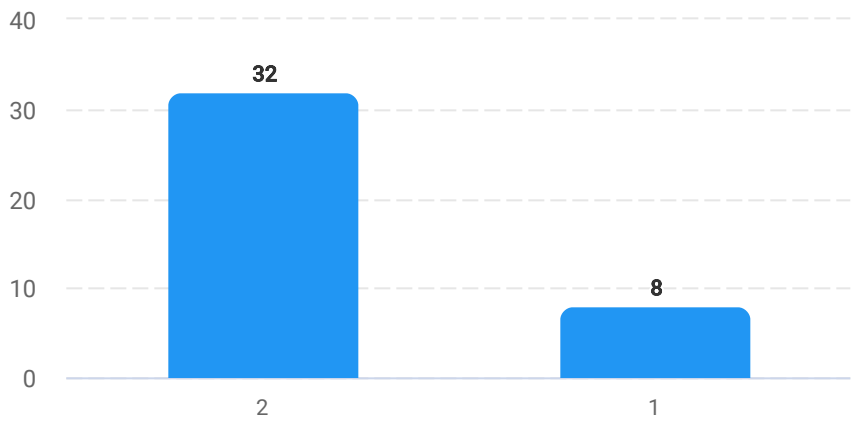
11

Is this course required?

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
2	Yes	32
1	No	8



Average
1.80
Median
2.00
Mode
2
Std. Dev.
0.40
Variance
0.16

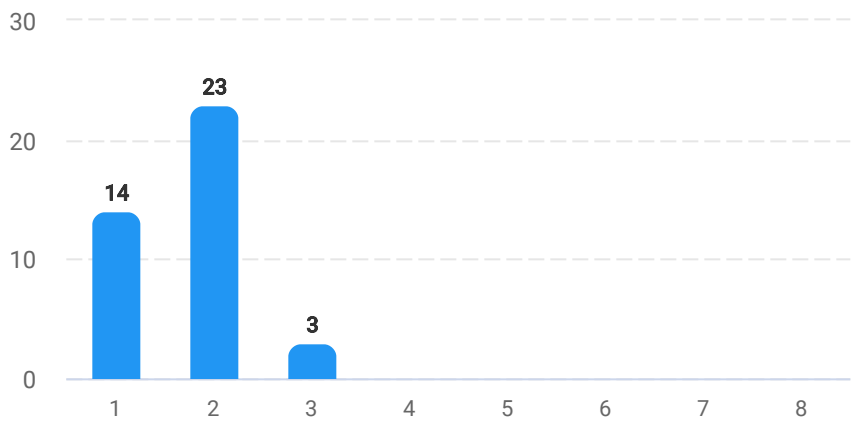
12

Expected Grade in this Course

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Institution Question

Value	Option	Total
1	A	14
2	B	23
3	C	3
4	D	0
5	F	0
6	I	0
7	S	0
8	U	0



Average
1.73
Median
2.00
Mode
2
Std. Dev.
0.59
Variance
0.35

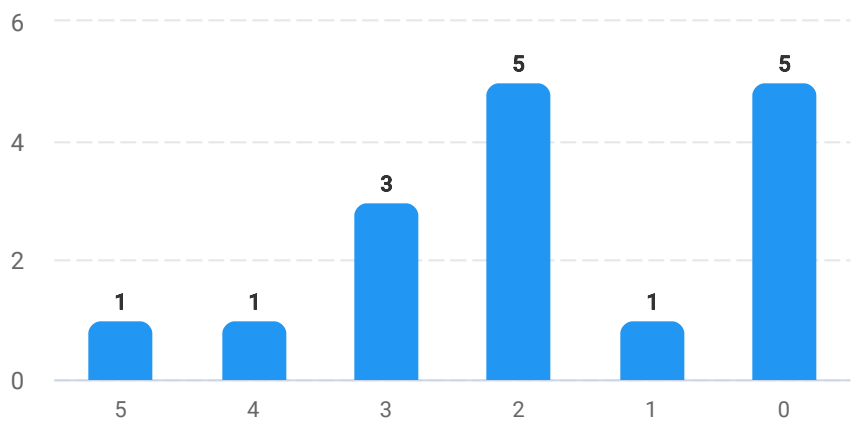
13

I found the required textbook for this course useful.

(Multi-Choice, Single Answer)

Department Question

Value	Option	Total
5	Strongly Agree	1
4	Agree	1
3	Undecided	3
2	Disagree	5
1	Strongly Disagree	1
0	N/A (no textbook was required)	5



Average
2.64
Median
2.00
Mode
2,0
Std. Dev.
1.07
Variance
1.14

Student Comments:

- The textbook does not explain things well.

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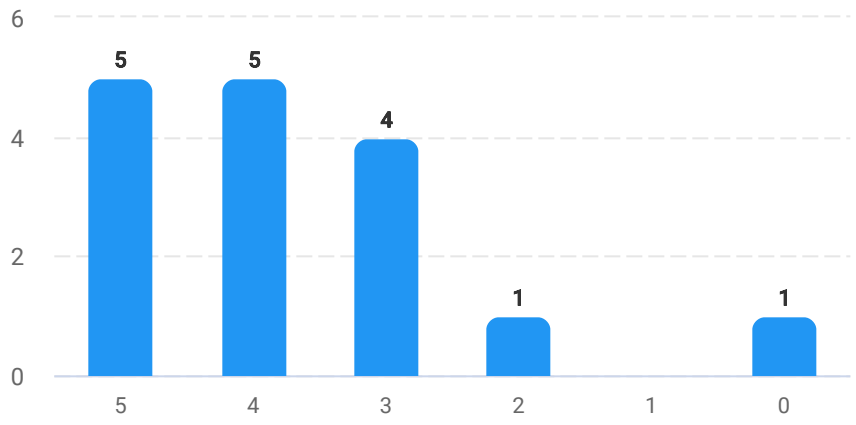
14 I found the online materials posted by my instructor useful.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
5	Strongly Agree	5
4	Agree	5
3	Undecided	4
2	Disagree	1
1	Strongly Disagree	0
0	N/A (no textbook was required)	1



Average
3.93
Median
4.00
Mode
5,4
Std. Dev.
0.93
Variance
0.86

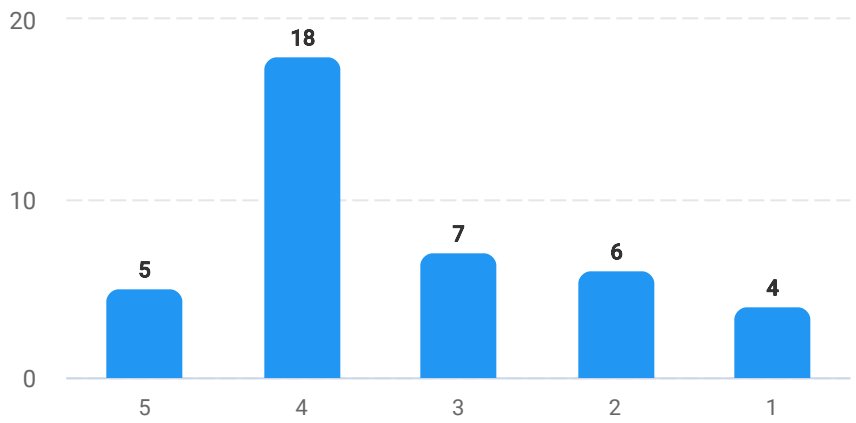
15 My instructor explained concepts clearly.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
5	Strongly Agree	5
4	Agree	18
3	Undecided	7
2	Disagree	6
1	Strongly Disagree	4



Average
3.35
Median
4.00
Mode
4
Std. Dev.
1.17
Variance
1.38

Student Comments:

- He would often jump around from topic to topic. He wouldn't explain topics clearly and would often get his own example problems wrong. I had a very difficult time following his work or understanding why a concept was important. I only really understood once I read the book.
- Often time his was confused himself, which just confused me more.
- I ususally left class confused, and he made easy topics difficult to understand.
- The professor would try, but I would be more confused by his explanations and oftentimes would just use the typed words in the notes to better understand the concepts.
- The instructor wasn't always the best at explaining certain concepts, and a lot of the material taught in class I was seeing for the first time. I think I would've done better in the class if the instructor explained topics a bit better.

16

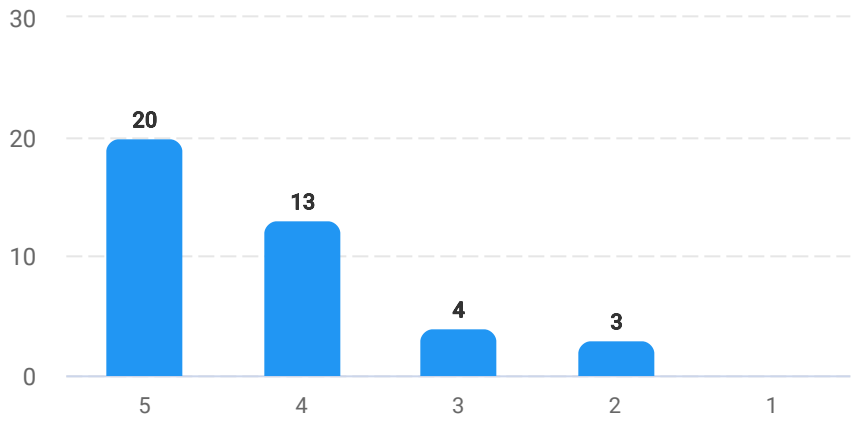
My instructor was receptive to students asking questions in class.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
5	Strongly Agree	20
4	Agree	13
3	Undecided	4
2	Disagree	3
1	Strongly Disagree	0



Average
4.25

Median
4.50

Mode
5

Std. Dev.
0.92

Variance
0.84

Student Comments:

- He was always open and ready to answer questions. He always tried to be helpful and welcomed questions even in the middle of lecture.
- He tried to answer the questions, but often times, wouldn't and would answer something completely different and not asked.
- Always willing to help students and provides detailed explanation :)

17

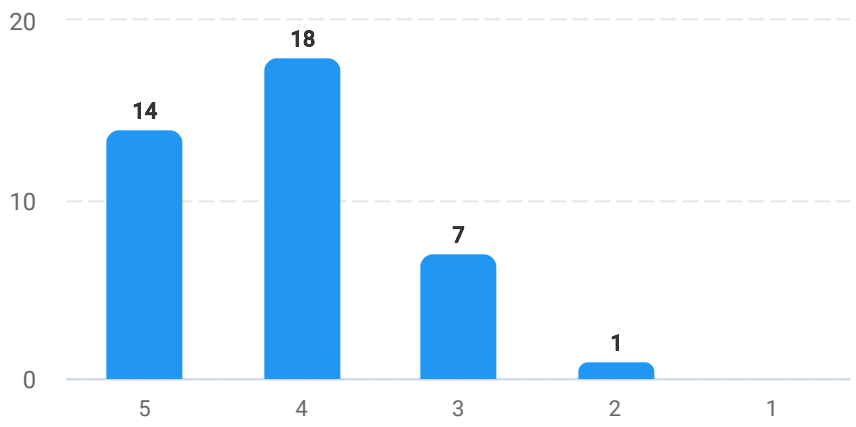
My instructor was accessible outside of class.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
5	Strongly Agree	14
4	Agree	18
3	Undecided	7
2	Disagree	1
1	Strongly Disagree	0



Average
4.13

Median
4.00

Mode
4

Std. Dev.
0.78

Variance
0.61

Student Comments:

- I never tried to access him outside of class
- Answered emails quickly

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18

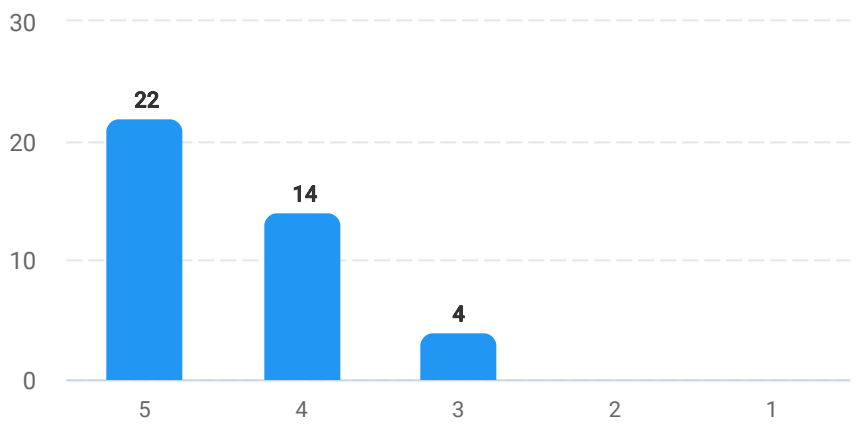
My instructor fostered a learning environment that was respectful of all students.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
5	Strongly Agree	22
4	Agree	14
3	Undecided	4
2	Disagree	0
1	Strongly Disagree	0



Average
4.45

Median
5.00

Mode
5

Std. Dev.
0.67

Variance
0.45

Student Comments:

- He respected his students fine enough.

Word Cloud Not Available

No text to process or the text does not contain words occurring at least 2 times.

19

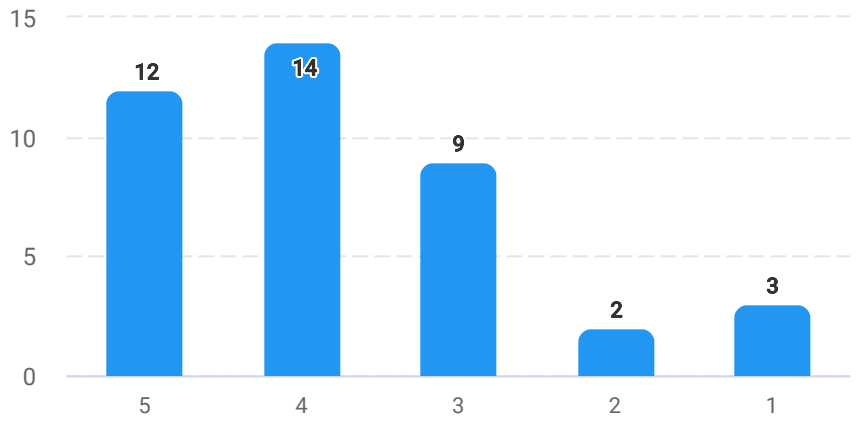
Overall, my instructor was effective.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
5	Strongly Agree	12
4	Agree	14
3	Undecided	9
2	Disagree	2
1	Strongly Disagree	3



Average
3.75
Median
4.00
Mode
4
Std. Dev.
1.16
Variance
1.34

Student Comments:

- Really, he just filled in notes, I don't feel like he was a very effective instructor.
- Would be helpful in assisting with homework and with clarifying misconceptions, but it was very hard to understand material during class, and I would oftentimes feel lost.

feel

20

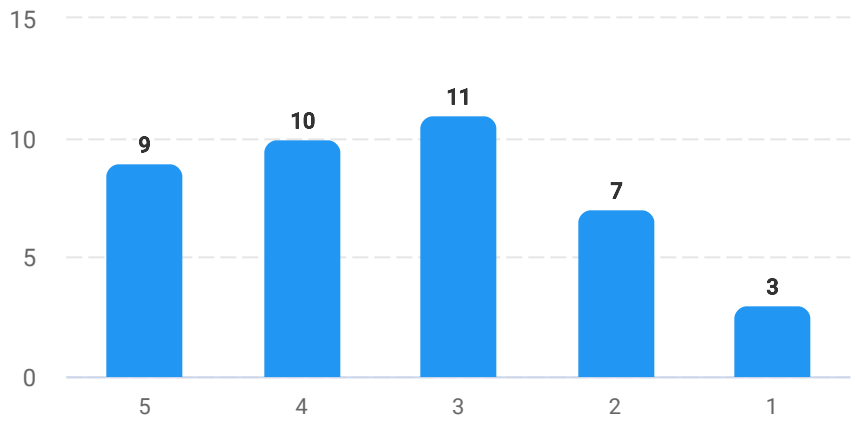
I would recommend my instructor to another student.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

Value	Option	Total
5	Strongly Agree	9
4	Agree	10
3	Undecided	11
2	Disagree	7
1	Strongly Disagree	3



Average
3.38
Median
3.00
Mode
3
Std. Dev.
1.22
Variance
1.48

Student Comments:

- While I liked him as a person, he just was not an effective instructor

Word Cloud Not Available

No text to process or the text does not contain words occurring at least 2 times.

21

What did your instructor do that you found particularly helpful?

(Instructor Text/Memo)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

- Explaining a problem step by step when asked to do so.
- Professor Pal was nice and respectful when students ask questions.
- Answered a lot of questions during class
- Was willing to provide examples to explain things in more depth.
- not a lot
- answered questions. gave lots of examples. worked out questions
-
- He was very open to questions
- He was always willing to explain something again, take questions, etc.
- He was receptive to students asking questions and answering them!
- Was very understanding
- always made sure to reserve time in class for questions
- If his student's were confused on a concept/questions he would take extra time to further explain it.
- Answering my emails quickly
- He let us ask as many questions.
- Notes
- Provided extra credit and dropped quiz grades
- Was always helpful and understanding and always encouraged students to do their best while still challenging us to better ourselves and our skills.
- The test review session we had before all the test where very helpful to remind me off what was going to be on the test
- Going over review questions a few days before the test was very helpful.
- Broke things down.
- Ask for questions in between topics
- Arpan was always easy to reach and created a comfortable environment to learn.
- N/a
- Always available to answer questions. Doesn't make you feel dumb
- We would continue to go over problems of the same variety until it was fully understood
- Answer all questions asked, and provided help when requested/ needed.
- Relating concepts in real-life terms.
- He would always answer students's questions in class which was very helpful.
- He walked through concepts and also reviewed questions or different concepts that we struggled on with quizzes or on tests.

22 What would you recommend that your instructor change?

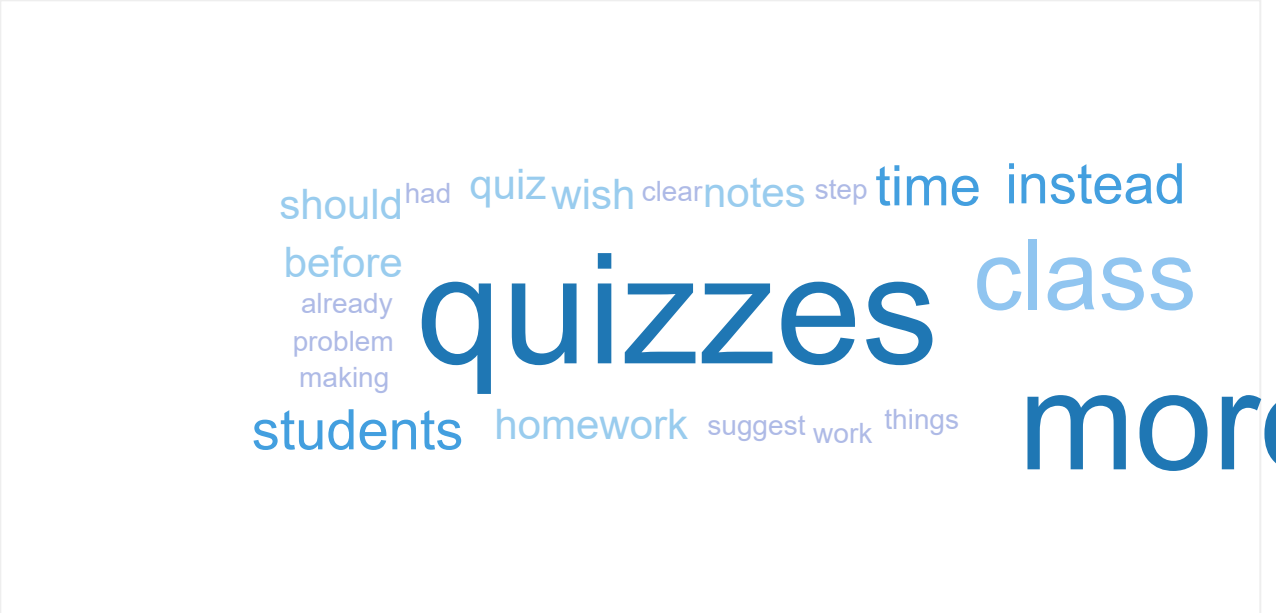
(Instructor Text/Memo)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

- I think he should explain each problem step by step instead of assuming the students already know how to do it or what it means.
- I suggest making the agenda of the class and the notes more organized.
- Make clear the expectations of what work should be shown
- I wish he would’ve have taken the time to explain things in more basic terms.
- career choice
- nothing
-
- Make the quizzes the same day every week, like Friday. Provide filled-in notes online. Explain the significance of what we're learning more.
- The quizzes should be more reflective of what we learn in class.
- I despised the weekly quizzes but can see their purpose. Maybe make them less frequent, give students time to study so they can use it as a benchmark for the upcoming tests.
- Quizzes. We had over 12 quizzes this semester and if the class average was below a 50 (which happened more than once) instead of re-explaining or not taking it, he would just turn around and give us another quiz over different information. It was not benefical for anyone and left many of us stressed.
- More examples in class
- none
- Present a clear understanding what units our quizzes would be over.
- Try to see what the homework has in terms of lesson plans. If there is a piece of homework not taught in class perhaps teach it in class or extend homework.
- more practice problems
- Get more organized before class
- Teaching habits
- Pop quizzes! We are so busy with other classes sometimes we don’t have time to study before every class, would like to know when most quizzes were.
- I honestly can’t think of anything to change.
- No pop quizzes. Take home or group quizzes instead. Opportunity for some bonus test points for one of the tests.
- I wish he didn’t skip over examples. And I wish he would reiterate an idea and write down the entire problem rather than abbreviate when we are learning.
- Doing notes before the are made available
- Less lecture, more "hands-on"/learning through doing.
- N/a
- Just better organizatio
- We kept jumping back and forth between chapters to either take old quizzes when we had already moved on to a new chapter
- I would recommend that he explain things more concisely, and that he work problems in class that reflect what we would see on homework, quizzes and tests (especially in terms of difficulty). Other professors have done this, and I found that it really boosted my understanding, since I didn't spend so much time confused about what a question was asking, since I was familiar with it, and therefore, I could focus on the execution of the problem.
- Working through more examples and of a variety of applications.
- Teach a bit more of the basics or explain topics in more detail.
- The concept of pop quizzes prevented effective learning with a constant fear of being tested instead of the desire to learn being the motivator for learning. I would suggest students be aware when a quiz is or making a

desire to learn being the motivator for learning. I would suggest students be aware when a quiz is or making a specific quiz day for students to prepare in advance.



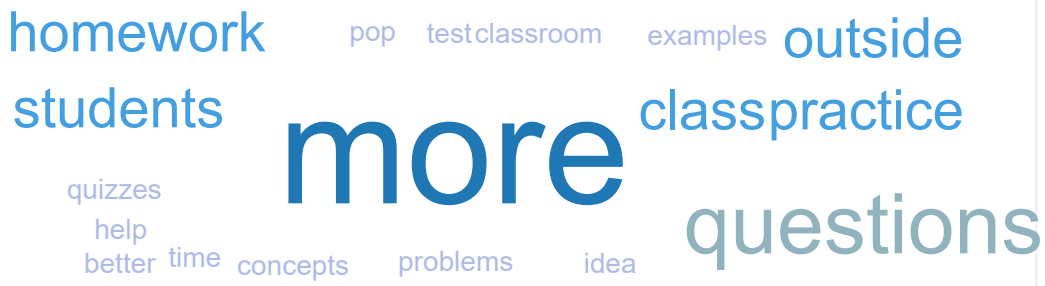
23 What, if anything, could your instructor have done to better facilitate your learning in this course?

(Instructor Text/Memo)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

- He could have made the zoom recordings available to anyone that had been absent.
- Provide more practice questions to do outside of class.
- more practice questions outside of homework
-
- More examples in class
- none
- Kept our classroom in the ILCB and not HELDS
- doing reviews that directly reflect the test
- No pop quizzes as it does not help students succeed in this course. While it should be expected that students study outside classroom, having pop quizzes is no indicator of a student's skill. Some students like to prepare thoroughly for all courses and can't divide time management appropriately if they are trying to anticipate a possible quiz.
- Maybe get more organized before glass
- Try to explain concepts better and clearer
- More test review materials
- Not much. Maybe allowing slightly more time on exams?
- Working some homework problems in class would help a lot since some of the homework questions were confusing or did not relate to what we did in class.
- Fine more examples and not abbreviate an idea especially a new idea, but write it out.
- Only complain is the building the class took place in.
- N/a
- nothing
- Have a better organization of the topics. It felt weird learning interest and other concepts months after profit and demand.
- Integrate regular clicker questions to ensure understanding of conceptual things, and have the clicker be worth very little in points so that it facilitates learning rather than discourages the students.
- Provide more structure in the course.
- Go over more practice problems.



24 My TA explained concepts clearly.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

25 My TA was accessible outside of class.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

26 My TA fostered a learning environment that was respectful of all students.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

27 My TA was receptive to students asking questions in class and supplied clear explanations.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

28 Overall, my TA was effective.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

29 I would recommend my TA to another student.

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

Department Question

30 Please add your overall thoughts on the course and instructor.

(Instructor Text/Memo)

Department Question

Arpan Pal Instructor

- At first, I struggled to understand the instructor. Once I got used to the subtle accent, I began understanding more. The homework definitely helps a lot and gives good practice. In lecture the instructor tends to give us the "short" answer first and doesn't explain step by step until a student asks for him to do so.
- I have taken this course once before and found it hard the first time because of the professor but this time I was very successful in the class. Arpan was very encouraging and treated us students as people, knowing how to take a joke and make class engaging and entertaining. Overall he is a great guy who really does want you to succeed and I would recommend him to anyone taking this course.
- You were a great instructor Arpan. Thanks for answering all of our questions and creating a light hearted environment.
- Overall, I think he taught the required material and gave us opportunities to improve our own understanding of the topics covered.
- In general, anything Arpan explained was incoherent. This was supposed to be the easiest of my three required math courses, and I expect to get a C. There is no reason this level of material should be so difficult to understand. He was unable to clearly answer students questions and we often just sat there and watched him solve problems while he said “and if it says this, then you go like this. and then you do this. and it should look like this”. The majority of this course was over probability. THREE units over one concept that he doesn’t know how to teach. I would say it is very probable that Arpan is the reason my GPA will drop.
- :)) i liked this class
-
- I really liked the professor and I thought some of the topics were interesting but overall I didn't find him or the class to be very helpful.
- This class shouldn't have been as difficult or stressful as it was. He took easy concepts and found a way to make them confusing. The homework was not useful or reflective of the type of problems we did in class. The pop quizzes were meant to help us, but hurt us more than anything. I could make A's on the tests, but that was not he case on the quizzes. In class quicker questions would be better to insure class participation and attendance.
- Overall, a solid instructor
- Great person, and is extremely funny; just not meant to be the head instructor of the course. Would of been better if he was an assistant.
- Good instructor
- very informative and well organized class
- amazing guy, okay teacher
- The course was tough and had a lot of information but Arpan Pal did a good job of making it manageable.
- Decent professor and course, provided opportunities to get additional help for course,
- Arpan is a great teacher. He truly wants his students to succeed.
- Instructor is really nice, but the teaching skills can be improved
- He was caring about his students. He would try to get grade higher at the end and would answer us fast. Need to work on lecturing and online materials.
- This instructor was incredible and genuinely one of my favorites out of all the instructors I’ve ever had; including high school.
- He was a good teacher and always tried his best the get the point across so that every one would understand. He never got frustrated or annoyed with the questions asked in class.
- Great guy and obviously really cares about his students. Just change some of the class structure to make it less stressful to learn and less emphasis on grades.
- I thought he was very prepared, knowledgeable, respectful, and helpful. He helped a lot during office hours. Very accessible and flexible with grading and help

- Very accessible and flexible with grading and help.
- I enjoyed the course.
- N/a
- He really wants his students to succeed. Could be better organized
- He was great and a fun teacher to have.
- He was very nice and very helpful. However, help was only given if asked, and it would take many questions in order to clarify the many things that were confusing in class.
- Very kind and wants to help his students, but not the best at explaining certain topics.
- Welcoming atmosphere but strained whenever the fear of quizzes was present.